



OMNIKON

Open Source • Community Driven • Student Powered

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Hackathon Rulebook

1. Eligibility & Registration

- All participants must register through the official registration portal.
- The GitHub repository **must be created only after 15 August 2026** (the date official Problem Statements are released), and only after registration is complete. Repositories created before **15 August 2026** or before registration will not be accepted.
- Teams must consist of **1 or 2 members only** (Solo or Duo).
- All team members must have contributed approximately equal work to the project.
- Every team member must be listed as a contributor on the GitHub repository.
- All team members must be clearly mentioned as contributors in the project documentation (`README.md`), including their GitHub usernames and roles.
- **Important:** Only registered participants of the team may contribute to the project. Any contribution from non-registered individuals will result in **immediate disqualification**. AI agents and automated tools are exempt from this rule.
- Participants must be currently enrolled students (undergraduate, postgraduate, or equivalent). Proof of enrollment may be requested at any stage.
- Each participant may be part of **only one team**. Cross-team participation is strictly prohibited and will result in disqualification of both teams.

2. Hackathon Rounds

The hackathon is conducted in **two rounds**. Progression to Round 2 is based on shortlisting after Round 1 evaluation.

ROUND 1 — IDEA SUBMISSION

Concept & PDF Report

- Participants must submit a **PDF document** explaining their project idea using the **official template provided by Omnikon Org**. No prototype or live showcase is required at this stage.
- The PDF must clearly describe: the **problem statement chosen**, proposed solution, tech stack, expected impact, and team details.
- The PDF must not exceed **10 pages**.
- Submissions will be reviewed by the judging panel. Only **shortlisted teams** will advance to Round 2. Results will be communicated via email and Discord.
- The GitHub repository must be created (only on or after **15 August 2026**) and made public before Round 1 submission, but no working code is mandatory at this stage.
- The Round 1 PDF must include a **"Reviewer Notes"** section for any additional context you wish to provide to the judges.

Build, Deploy & Present

- Shortlisted teams must submit a **PowerPoint presentation (PPT)** for the project showcase using the **official PPT template provided by Omnikon Org**.
- The PPT must cover: project demo screenshots/links, architecture, technical implementation, challenges faced, results, and future scope.
- A **live deployed service** must be accessible at the time of submission. This can be a web app, mobile app, AI model endpoint, browser extension, or any publicly accessible product.
- A **project showcase video** (2-5 minutes) must be submitted alongside the PPT, demonstrating the working product.
- The deployed link must be added in the **"About"** section of the GitHub repository.
- All documentation (`README.md` , `LICENSE` , `SECURITY.md`) must be complete and up to date before Round 2 submission.
- No changes may be made to the repository **after the Round 2 submission deadline**. Any post-deadline commits will result in disqualification.

3. Project Requirements

3.1 Core Technical Rules

1. The project **must** be hosted as a **public open-source repository** on GitHub under the Omnikon Org organization (or properly linked).
2. A live **deployed service** is mandatory by Round 2. This can be a web app, mobile app, AI model endpoint, browser extension, or any publicly accessible product.
3. The project **must** be built under one of the official Problem Statements announced for the hackathon.
4. The project **must not** be a copy, fork, or direct derivative of any existing project.
5. Proper data security practices must be followed. Any project handling user data must include a `SECURITY.md` file.
6. The project must be **original work started after registration**. Projects begun before the hackathon start date are ineligible.
7. All third-party APIs, libraries, datasets, and tools must be properly attributed in the `README.md` and PDF/PPT submissions.

3.2 Documentation Requirements

- A comprehensive `README.md` with setup instructions, tech stack, demo link, and a clear list of all team members and their contributions.
- A valid open-source **LICENSE** file (MIT, Apache 2.0, or GPL recommended).
- A `SECURITY.md` file detailing how data is handled and protected.
- A `CONTRIBUTING.md` file (*recommended*).
- A `CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md` file (*recommended*).

4. Submission Requirements

- **Round 1:** A PDF report (max 10 pages) using the official Omnikon template, explaining the project idea. Architecture, tech stack, expected challenges, and results must be included.
- **Round 2:** A PPT presentation using the official Omnikon template, demonstrating the built and deployed project.
- The deployed link must be added in the **"About"** section of the GitHub repository before Round 2 submission.
- A **project showcase video** (2-5 minutes) must be submitted in Round 2.
- Any notes specifically intended for reviewers must be clearly mentioned in both the PDF (Round 1) and PPT (Round 2) under a section titled **"Reviewer Notes"**.

- Submissions must be made through the official submission form/portal before the respective round deadline. Late submissions will not be accepted under any circumstances.
- Use of generative AI tools is allowed but **must be disclosed** in the `README.md` and submission documents.

5. Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Weight	Description
Innovation & Originality	25%	Creativity and novelty of the solution
Technical Implementation	25%	Code quality, architecture, and functionality
Impact & Usefulness	20%	Real-world applicability and problem-solving
Documentation & Presentation	15%	README, PDF/PPT quality, and video clarity
Security & Compliance	15%	Data handling and responsible development

Note on Round 1 Evaluation

Round 1 is evaluated solely on the PDF submission — the quality of the idea, clarity of the problem-solution fit, and feasibility of the proposed approach. Technical implementation is not assessed in Round 1.

6. Prizes & Recognition



1ST PLACE

₹5,000



2ND PLACE

₹3,000



3RD PLACE

₹2,000

🏆 Top 10 Teams — Special Recognition

- All teams finishing in the **Top 10** will receive an official **Participation Certificate** from Omnikon Org.
- All **Top 10 teams** will also receive **special exclusive gifts** curated by the Omnikon team.
- Winners and top performers will be featured on Omnikon's official social media channels, website, and GitHub organization page.
- Top 3 teams will receive a **winner's badge** on their Omnikon contributor profile.

Prize Disbursement

Cash prizes will be disbursed within 15 working days after the final results are announced. Winners must submit valid bank/UPI details through the official prize collection form. Prizes are awarded per team, not per individual member.

7. Code of Conduct

- All participants must follow the Omnicon Org Code of Conduct.
- Harassment, plagiarism, or toxic behavior will lead to **immediate disqualification**.
- Use of generative AI tools is allowed but **must be disclosed** in the `README.md` and all submission documents.
- Third-party APIs and libraries must be properly credited.
- Participants must maintain respectful communication on all Omnicon platforms including Discord, GitHub discussions, and email threads.
- Any attempt to manipulate the judging process, gain unfair advantage, or misrepresent work will result in permanent disqualification and a ban from future Omnicon events.
- Participants are expected to be available for clarification calls or demos if requested by the judging panel during evaluation.

8. Grounds for Disqualification

- Creating the GitHub repository before **15 August 2026** or before completing registration.
- Submitting copied, plagiarized, or previously submitted projects.
- Missing mandatory deliverables (Round 1 PDF, Round 2 PPT, video, deployed link, documentation).
- Contribution from non-registered individuals to the project.
- Violating the Code of Conduct or engaging in unethical behavior.
- Making changes to the project after the submission deadline of either round.
- Submitting a project that does not align with any of the announced official Problem Statements.
- A participant being registered in more than one team simultaneously.
- Providing false information during registration or in submission documents.
- Failure to disclose the use of generative AI tools or third-party resources in submission documents.

9. Intellectual Property

- All projects submitted remain the **intellectual property of the respective teams**. Omnicon Org claims no ownership over participant submissions.
- By submitting, participants grant Omnicon Org the right to feature their project (name, description, screenshots) on official platforms for promotional purposes.
- Projects must be released under an open-source license. The license file must be included in the repository.
- If a project incorporates third-party code or assets, proper licensing compliance is the sole responsibility of the participating team.

10. Important Notes

Reviewer Notes Section

All teams must include a clearly labeled section titled **"Reviewer Notes"**

in both their Round 1 PDF and Round 2 PPT submission. This is where any special instructions, known limitations, or additional context for judges should be written.

Repository Creation Policy

The GitHub repository for your project must be created

only on or after 15 August 2026

(the official Problem Statement release date), and only after your registration is complete. Any repository with commits dated before

15 August 2026

or before your registration timestamp will be flagged and may lead to disqualification.

Omnikon Org reserves the right to update these rules at any time. All changes will be communicated via official channels (Discord & email). Participants are responsible for staying updated.

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For any queries, reach out at contact@omnikonhub.com